

4.1 Unit description

Options

This unit offers **six** optional research options:

Option 1: Tectonic Activity and Hazards

Option 2: Cold Environments – Landscapes and Change

Option 3: Life on the Margins: the Food Supply Problem

Option 4: The World of Cultural Diversity

Option 5: Pollution and Human Health at Risk

Option 6: Consuming the Rural Landscape – Leisure and Tourism.

Students research one option

Students must select and study **one** research option from the above list that reflects their geographical interests.

Options in this unit range from those with a strong physical geography focus, to those concerned more with environmental, social and cultural geographies.

The options are designed to expose students to a range of geographical information in a variety of forms, namely books, journals, video and the internet. Many of these will be unfamiliar in terms of context and content. Part of this holistic exploration will involve linking content and concepts from Units 1, 2 and 3 into students' research.

Global synoptic contexts

The global synoptic context sets each option within a wider context to encourage synoptic links both within this unit, and Unit 3. Each of the six research options promote in-depth research of a key area of geography. Before embarking on detailed research, students should briefly investigate their chosen topic using the global synoptic context as a guide. Teachers may allow students to explore a number of global synoptic contexts before students make their final decision about which research option to select. There are three broad initial questions which students should explore. Teachers may wish to use group work, presentations and other active learning strategies within teaching groups to allow students to share their initial research and ideas.